We're Cured!

SHOW & BOOTH CHECKLIST

Everything learned from the November 2026 gift show, in one place. The big idea: **show less, light it well, and let the colours glow against black.** Space around a piece tells people it's art.

BEFORE YOU BOOK A SHOW

- [ ] **Ask the organiser how many people came last year** and what sort of things sold.
- [ ] **Ask what the other vendors sell.** Lots of food, kits and resale = a bargain crowd.
- [ ] **Ask other vendors how it went for them** — they'll usually be honest.
- [ ] **Visit as a shopper first** if you can. Look at the lighting, and whether people are carrying bags out.
- [ ] **Ask if booth fabric has to be flame-retardant.**
- [ ] **Ask if there's power at the booth** (and whether it costs extra), and how far the outlet is.
- [ ] **Ask for a booth on a busy aisle or a corner** if they let you choose.

TO BUY OR GATHER

- [ ] **Black matte fabric for behind each rack** — black queen flat sheets work. Flame-retardant if the show asks.
- [ ] **Big binder clips or bulldog clips** and **zip ties** (plus scissors to cut the ties).
- [ ] **Black matte tablecloth that reaches the floor** — not satin, not white.
- [ ] **3–4 warm LED clip-on lights** (not white work lamps), an extension cord and a power bar.
- [ ] **Battery LED puck lights** to tuck under or behind see-through pieces so they glow.
- [ ] **LED light pad** (tracing / diamond-painting kind) to backlight a few pendants.
- [ ] **5–6 empty wine bottles** — a mix of colours. Soak the labels off, or keep pretty ones.
- [ ] **2–3 more busts or necklace stands** at different heights.
- [ ] **Plate stands and small risers** so flat pieces stand up instead of lying down.
- [ ] **A small mirror** for trying on pendants.
- [ ] **Plastic bins that fit under the table** for back stock.
- [ ] **Coloured dot stickers** (green, blue, yellow) for the bottoms of the wine stoppers.
- [ ] **UV flashlight and a small dark box** — “peek inside to see them glow!” for the Monster Splats.

PACKING THE STOCK

- [ ] **Pick 3–5 “hero” pieces** — the showstoppers that pull people in from the aisle.
- [ ] **Bring about half of everything**, and plan to put out only a third of that.
- [ ] **One of each coaster style on display**, the rest boxed underneath.
- [ ] **Choose 20–30 pendants to display**, the rest in a box to refill from.

- [ ] **Pack the Monster Splats** — they were the biggest crowd-pleaser.
- [ ] **Signs:** QR table sign, Spilled sign, wine stopper sign, and an “All pendants $50” sign.
- [ ] **Business cards**, bags, tissue, gift tags, tape, pen, notebook.
- [ ] **Phone charged**, charger, card reader, cash float.

SETTING UP

- [ ] **Table at the front or along one side** (an L-shape), so people can browse from the aisle without stepping in.
- [ ] **Jewellery closest to the aisle** — small, detailed pieces need to be up close.
- [ ] **Black fabric behind every rack**, reaching the floor to hide back stock.
- [ ] **Heroes at eye level**, with space around each one and a light on it.
- [ ] **Group by colour or theme** — blues and oceans together, autumn and sunflowers together, pinks together.
- [ ] **Leave gaps on every shelf.** If a shelf looks full, take something off.
- [ ] **Nothing on the floor.** Anything at foot level looks like overflow.
- [ ] **Pendants hanging from the resin hands**, a few on busts, a few backlit on the light pad.
- [ ] **Wine stoppers: a few in bottles, the rest in one of your own bowls** with the sign beside them.
- [ ] **Puck lights under the see-through pieces**, clip lights aimed at the shelves.
- [ ] **Price on everything**, and signs where one price covers a group.
- [ ] **Walk out into the aisle and look from 10 feet away.** What catches your eye first? Is it a hero piece?
- [ ] **Take booth photos** before the doors open.

DURING THE SHOW

- [ ] **Refill from the bins** as things sell — keep the gaps.
- [ ] **Stand, and say hello** to anyone who stops.
- [ ] **Jot down what people pick up** and anything they say about prices.
- [ ] **Hand a card to everyone who lingers** — “we ship anywhere in Canada.”

AFTERWARDS

- [ ] **List what sold**, to whom, and at what price.
- [ ] **Note what got the most attention**, even if it didn't sell.
- [ ] **Post the crowd favourites on Instagram** so people who took a card can find them again.
- [ ] **Send Claude the booth photos and your notes** to update this list.

> **Remember:** one quiet show doesn't mean the work or the prices are wrong. The right room matters more than anything on this list.